



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: New Covenant Christian Academy

School Website: <https://newcovenantchristianacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

New Covenant Christian Academy (Interlochen, MI 49643) presents a clear classical Christian orientation in its public-facing materials. The school identifies itself explicitly as a discipleship-driven, evangelical program that integrates theology, worship, and biblical worldview into daily life and study. It also emphasizes classical pedagogy through Trivium-based learning (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and a focus on forming wisdom and virtue, with mission language such as "Glorifying God through Wisdom and Virtue." In curriculum, the school foregrounds grammar-logic-rhetoric and the Trivium, with explicit attention to language study (Latin begins in second grade) and the Quadrivium in later study. Pedagogical practices suggested by the site align with some classical elements (e.g., chanting/memory and/or Socratic-style engagement are not explicitly described on the site, but the grammar-logic-rhetoric structure and Latin emphasis point toward classical methods). The faculty material suggests teachers function as living exemplars and mentors, and parents are positioned as partners in a Christian formation process. Taken together, the school ranks as CLASSICAL overall, with some category-level caveats where explicit Great Books, explicit Socratic pedagogy, or a more detailed, explicit Great-Conversation orientation are not clearly documented on the site.

Key drivers for CLASSICAL classification:

- Religious/metaphysical foundations are explicit (discipleship, evangelical identity, liturgical practices, weekly chapel, prayer and Scripture integrated into classes, theology-informed worldview)
- Purpose/goal centers formation, virtue, wisdom, and God-centered aims (Glorifying God through Wisdom and Virtue; formation over mere information; tools of learning to become independent learners)
- Curriculum foregrounds Trivium/Quadrivium and language study (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; Latin beginning in Grade 2)
- Pedagogy mirrors classical structures in naming the Trivium and the goal of forming thinkers, with a clear emphasis on classical aims (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; some aspects of memory/recitation implied by classical approach, though not extensively documented on site)
- Faculty portrayals evoke mentors living the curriculum and modeling virtue; staff are described as aligned with Christian faith and content knowledge, bridging content and biblical belief
- Parents and community are positioned as partners in formation; open invitation and active involvement are indicated (parents as co-teachers in the classical formation project)

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents itself as a discipleship and evangelical institution, embedding Christian faith and biblical practice in daily life (weekly Chapel; prayer and Scripture integrated across classes)

- Mission materials state “Glorifying God through Wisdom and Virtue,” signaling transcendent moral aims and a theologically oriented worldview
- The Tenets of Faith page and related materials indicate explicit theology and doctrinal grounding in the school’s ethos

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, God, theology, liturgy/worship/chapel, prayer, Scripture, sacred worldview, reverence, and a sacramental/incarnational frame (as evidenced by explicit statements about faith and daily spiritual practices)
- Negative keywords: not evident in public materials (no explicit secularism or value-neutral framing observed)

Why this rating

- The materials demonstrate a robust religious/metaphysical orientation anchored in Christian theology, liturgical practice, and a moral formation aim, which aligns strongly with the classical category’s expectations for theological grounding and liturgical community life rather than secular humanism or relativism. The explicit language around worship, biblical worldview, and mission-centered virtue supports a CLASSICAL designation here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school’s stated aim centers on formation of wisdom and virtue (formation of character and intellect within a Christian framework) rather than purely job preparation; the “tools of learning” language foregrounds formation of independent, thoughtful learners.
- The mission/vision lines emphasize God-centered aims (Glorifying God through Wisdom and Virtue) rather than vocational outcomes alone.
- The Trivium-based approach (grammar/logic/rhetoric) is presented as a foundation for deep learning and lifetime formation, not only transferable workforce skills.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education (in the classical sense), true/-good/beautiful oriented aims, contemplative posture (Scholé-like framing through classical pedagogy) (cite: Trivium framework and formation language)
- Negative keywords present: explicit job-preparation language is minimal; the site does not foreground 21st-century skills or workforce metrics as the main aim (absence of negative framing in public materials noted)

Why this rating

- The public materials consistently emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and ownership of learning through classical methods with a Christian lens, aligning with a CLASSICAL orientation for the School Purpose and Goal.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Explicit emphasis on the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and the Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as foundational disciplines, with the Grammar stage highlighting Latin study; this is a core classical curriculum signal.
- The site describes the Trivium and its three stages (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) as the pathway through K-12, leading to higher-level studies; this matches the traditional liberal-arts framework.

- Great Books/Great Conversation are not explicitly stated on the public site, which is a hallmark of many classical programs; the site emphasizes the Trivium/Quadrivium and Christian worldview rather than an explicit Great Books roster.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Quadrivium (arithmetic/geometry/music/astronomy), Latin (language study), Great Books/Great Conversation (not explicitly present; not used as a primary driver on the site), history across curriculum, “wonder” and integrated learning concepts from classical lexicon. The Trivium/Quadrivium framing is a strong positive indicator.
- Negative keywords present: absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation on the site reduces the completeness of the classic Great-Books signal; absence of explicit social studies framing in favor of historical study is not clearly documented. This contributes to a partially classical reading.

Why this rating

- While the program robustly incorporates the Trivium/Quadrivium and Latin, the public materials do not clearly document explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis. That gap makes the curriculum align with classical aims but not fully exhibit all six elements of classical curriculum as defined by the knowledge base. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Pedagogical framing centers on Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar for foundation, logic for relationships, rhetoric for articulation) as a central approach; this is the core classical pedagogy signal.
- The site references Latin study in the Grammar stage, signaling a structure in line with classical pedagogy (language-based memory and discipline).
- The material notes a balanced approach with formation and intellectual rigor; however, explicit statements about Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, or upper-level rhetoric speech opportunities are not clearly documented on the site. The presence of a classical framework without explicit documented Socratic methods lowers the certainty to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue (mentioned in the lexicon as a classical method) as a recognized element of classical pedagogy; deficit in explicit public mention of Socratic seminars or memory-based/chanting practices in the site’s public content; however, structural signals (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; Latin beginning in Grade 2) are strong positives.
- Negative keywords present: explicit, widely publicized Socratic seminars, scholé days, or memorization/recitation practices aren’t clearly documented on the site. This reduces full alignment to classical pedagogy signals.

Why this rating

- The program uses a clear Trivium-based framework and grammar/logic/rhetoric emphasis, but the public-facing documentation does not consistently announce all classical pedagogy markers (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars, memory-based recitation, or scholé-focused rests) in a way that is verifiable from the site alone. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site presents faculty as mentors and living exemplars who model virtue and knowledge; the staff page emphasizes Christian character and expertise, suggesting the living curriculum and a mentorship culture.

- Public materials convey that teachers are “experts in their content areas” who “bridge the gap between content and biblical beliefs,” which aligns with the classical ideal of the teacher as a virtuous exemplar and the core of the school’s living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentors, teachers as exemplars, virtue, character formation, mastery in content areas, teacher-student partnership in classical formation (as described on site).
- Negative keywords present: none clearly observed in public materials.

Why this rating

- The faculty portrayal aligns well with the classical ideal of virtuous, expert mentors who embody and transmit the school’s aims, earning CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents partnership with families, parental formation, and willingness for parents to engage as co-teachers in a classical formation process; families are described as welcome partners and involved in various activities.
- The site indicates opportunities for parent formation (through book studies and gatherings) and an open-campus approach (parents welcome to visit). These signals align with the classical emphasis on community formation and parental involvement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, engaged families, home-school partnership, open campus, parent participation, family rhythms.
- Negative keywords present: not evident in public materials.

Why this rating

- The public materials strongly support CLASSICAL labeling for Parents & Community due to explicit partnership language and active parent engagement signals.

Overall Classification (Aggregate)

- Core mix across categories: CLASSICAL in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations; CLASSICAL in Purpose/Goal; SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum and Pedagogy; CLASSICAL in Faculty; CLASSICAL in Parents & Community.
- Aggregate: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Explicitly document and publicize the Great Books/Great Conversation framework as part of the curriculum, including representative canonical texts, a stated plan for Great Books reading lists, and explicit connections to the Great Conversation within the Western canon. This would strengthen the category from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
- Concrete steps: publish a formal “Curriculum Overview” that names Great Books or core primary sources, a cross-curricular plan, and a stated progression from Grammar to Logic to Rhetoric with explicit historical/Western-canon anchors. Cite canonical texts (e.g., Homer, Plato, Augustine, Shakespeare) and show how Great Conversation informs along with the Trivium/Quadrivium.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Make explicit the use of Socratic dialogue and scholé-based practices in upper grades, plus a documented memory work/chanting component in lower grades, to align more fully with classical pedagogy signals.

- Concrete steps: publish a pedagogical framework page that describes how Socratic seminars, structured dialogues, and memory/recitation activities are implemented across grades, with sample lesson sequences.
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal) / Element 1 (Religious Foundations): Continue to foreground explicit discussion of “truth, goodness, beauty” as real transcendentals in daily academic work and in chapel/classroom integration; connect these transcendentals to specific course objectives and assessment rubrics to reinforce the formation narrative.
- Concrete steps: publish a reflective statement or course-embedding document tying truth/goodness/beauty to specific learning outcomes and assessment criteria across disciplines.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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